

Data Handling Reference Card

Reference card · For community banks and credit unions

For staff using AI tools. One page. Keep it within reach.

Before you paste anything

Ask three questions:

1. **What data class is this?** Green (public), Yellow (internal, non-customer), Red (NPI / PII / loan files).
2. **Is this an approved tool for that class?** If you're not certain, ask your manager before pasting.
3. **Could a customer's name, account number, balance, SSN, or DOB be inferred from the context, even if not literally typed?** If yes, the data is Red.

The categories

GREEN — FREE TO USE

- Public information published by the bank or credit union
- Marketing language about the institution (no internal numbers)
- Generic banking concepts, regulatory citations, FAQs
- Synthetic / fictional examples clearly labeled as such

Examples: drafting a press release, summarizing a public 8-K, writing generic email templates with placeholders.

YELLOW — USE APPROVED TOOLS ONLY, STRIP IDENTIFIERS

- Internal policies and procedures
- Non-customer-specific operational data
- Drafts of communications that will be reviewed before sending

- Anonymized scenario walkthroughs

Examples: summarizing a board memo (with names removed), drafting an internal training module, refining policy language.

RED — NEVER PASTE INTO AI TOOLS, PUBLIC OR APPROVED

- Customer names + any identifier (account number, SSN, DOB, address)
- Loan files, credit applications, member account histories
- Transaction-level data tied to any identifier
- Adverse-action documentation
- Anything that would require disclosure under GLBA Privacy Rule
- Live BSA / SAR narratives or supporting documentation

If you need AI assistance on Red work, use only the institution's approved tool, strip identifiers first, and operate on the scrubbed text. When in doubt: do not paste; ask first.

The placeholder pattern

Replace identifying details with bracketed placeholders. The AI can still produce useful drafts on the structure.

- [CUSTOMER] , [MEMBER]
- [ACCOUNT NUMBER] , [LOAN ID]
- [BALANCE] , [TRANSACTION AMOUNT]
- [DATE] , [BRANCH]

Before you send the output

- Read every fact. AI tools make confident-sounding errors on numbers, dates, regulatory citations, and policy claims.
- Flag any uncertain claim with [VERIFY] and resolve before use.
- For customer-facing or regulated work, route through a human reviewer even if the prompt was Green-class.

Escalate any of these immediately

- A coworker pasting Red data into a public tool
- A vendor demo that asks for live customer data
- A policy gap you can't resolve from this card

- An AI output that contradicts your institution's stated policy

Citations

- GLBA Privacy Rule (Title V, Subtitle A) — confidentiality of nonpublic personal information
- AIEOG AI Lexicon, US Treasury / FBIIC / FSSCC, February 2026
- SR 11-7 Guidance on Model Risk Management, Federal Reserve / OCC
- Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Risk Management, Federal Reserve / OCC / FDIC